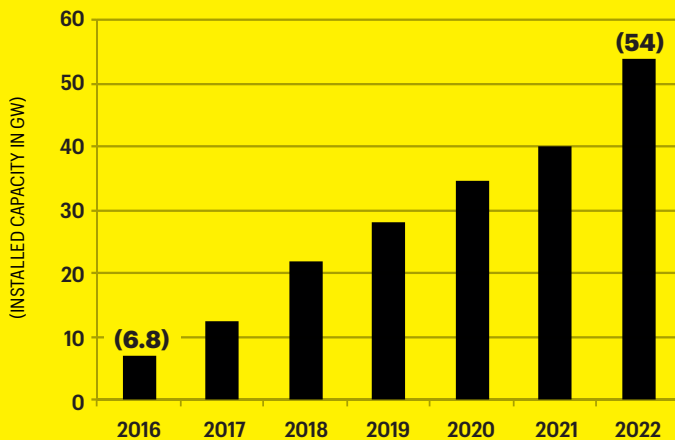


RAYS OF HOPE

India's solar energy capacity has grown at a CAGR of 41 per cent in the past seven years



SOURCE MINISTRY OF POWER AND MINISTRY OF NEW & RENEWABLE ENERGY



SEEDING A GREEN ECONOMY

Expansion of low-carbon industries such as green hydrogen and renewable batteries could potentially create an \$80-billion market in India by 2030

process by which sulphur is separated from fuels). Puri refers to a 2017 meeting he had with then-acting US energy secretary Grace Bochenek after being newly inducted into the Union Cabinet. “She made an unusual request of ‘one, for one, for one’. When I asked her to elaborate, she said 1 kg of green hydrogen for \$1 for 10 years; that made me reach out to our oil companies. I asked them how capable were they of bringing down the price to \$1?”

Ashish Gaikwad, MD of Honeywell Automation India, a leading integrated automation and software solutions provider, believes that all such new initiatives under sustainability are not only helping in the cause of making the country energy sufficient but will also strengthen the economy. “What could be better than [that] for a country like ours, which is dependent on supplies from outside for a large portion of its crude oil requirements? Other

than being a tricky situation for our energy security, it also takes a toll on our foreign exchange. If we reduce our import bill on that account, it is going to benefit the economy and make the rupee stronger as our trade balance improves,” he says.

The country's ambitious renewable energy targets are already acting as a catalyst for the transformation of its power sector, according to International Energy Agency (IEA) data. Going forward, it will be equally critical to put the industrial sector on the

same path, through more widespread electrification, material and energy efficiency, technologies such as carbon capture, utilisation and storage (CCUS) and a gradual shift to lower-carbon fuels, recommends IEA. However, it's not going to be easy. Tata Power's Sinha warns that challenges such as the over-dependency of the solar supply chain on foreign counterparts, financially ailing distribution companies, lack of transmission and distribution infrastructure, continued reliance on traditional fuels in some pockets of the country and lack of reliable electricity supply for rural consumers continue to impact the sector's transformation.

The government has been trying to address these issues through a wide policy framework. A production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme has been announced for GW-scale manufacturing of high-efficiency photovoltaic cells and a 40 per cent anti-dumping duty has been lev-

156.86 GIGAWATT

India's total installed renewable energy capacity as of November 2021—40 per cent of the 2030 target